How to Make Money with TikTok: 7 Legit Methods for New and Experienced Creators

7 Legit Methods · New & Experienced Creators | Updated October 28, 2026

TikTok offers creators multiple income opportunities, from the Creator Rewards Program and LIVE gifts to brand deals, affiliate marketing, and selling products.

TikTok can be a powerful platform for building an audience, but getting views is only one part of the process. If you are searching for **how to make money with TikTok**, you need to understand how creators turn attention, expertise, and content into actual income.

Some creators use TikTok's own monetization programs. Others earn through sponsorships, affiliate marketing, products, services, or user-generated content. There are also creators who use TikTok mainly as a free marketing channel for a separate business.

The right approach depends on your niche, audience, location, skills, and goals.

In this guide, we will cover seven legitimate ways to make money with TikTok, including options for beginners who are still building their first audience.

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Can You Make Money With TikTok?

Yes, TikTok can be used to generate income in multiple ways.

Potential income sources include:

* Creator monetization programs
* Brand partnerships
* Affiliate marketing
* Products and digital products
* Freelance services
* UGC
* Business and website traffic

However, creating an account and receiving views does not automatically mean you will get paid.

Each monetization method works differently, and some TikTok features have specific eligibility requirements or regional restrictions.

The most important step is choosing a method that fits the audience you are building.

1. Use TikTok's Creator Rewards Program

For eligible creators in supported markets, the Creator Rewards Program provides one way to potentially earn directly through TikTok.

It is designed around qualifying original content and has specific rules for participation.

Depending on the current program requirements, eligibility can involve factors such as:

* Minimum age
* Account standing

* Follower requirements
* Video views
* Original content
* Regional availability

Because TikTok can change its monetization programs, check the current information available inside your account before planning your income strategy around this feature.

What About the TikTok Creator Fund?

The **TikTok Creator Fund** is still a popular search term because it was one of TikTok's earlier creator monetization programs.

However, creators should distinguish the older Creator Fund from newer options such as the Creator Rewards Program.

If you find an old article explaining Creator Fund requirements or payment rates, check the publication date before using that information as a guide for your current account.

The monetization options available to you today may be different.

2. Make Money Through Brand Deals

Brand partnerships can become a significant income source once you have established a relevant audience.

A company may pay you to create content that features its product or service.

You might be asked to produce:

* A sponsored TikTok
* Product demonstration
* Tutorial
* Review
* Lifestyle video
* Brand integration
* Short-form advertisement
* UGC-style content

You do not always need a huge following.

Brands often care about whether the creator reaches the right audience.

For example, a small gaming account may be attractive to a company selling gaming accessories because its viewers are already interested in that category.

A technology account could potentially work with software companies or electronics brands.

How to Prepare for Sponsorships

Make your profile easy for brands to understand.

Clearly communicate:

* Your niche
* Your content style
* Your audience
* Your contact method

It also helps to create high-quality examples of the type of content you could produce for a company.

Never misrepresent sponsored content or personal product experience, and follow applicable disclosure requirements.

3. Start Affiliate Marketing

Affiliate marketing is one of the easiest concepts to understand.

You recommend a relevant product or service, and if someone completes a qualifying purchase or action through your referral, you can receive a commission.

You do not have to manufacture the product.

You can create content around products that genuinely fit your niche.

For example:

Technology

Create videos comparing apps, accessories, or software.

Beauty

Demonstrate products and explain how they are used.

Fitness

Discuss relevant equipment or tools.

Gaming

Show accessories, software, or gaming products.

Education

Recommend useful learning resources.

The key is to make the video useful first.

A product recommendation works better when the viewer understands why the product may solve a particular problem.

Affiliate Content Ideas

You can create:

* Product comparisons
* Tutorials
* Reviews
* "Best tools for..." videos
* Demonstrations
* Problem-solving videos
* Beginner guides

Always follow the affiliate program's terms and disclose commercial relationships where required.

4. Sell Products or Digital Products

If you already have something to sell, TikTok can help you reach potential customers.

Physical products can include:

* Clothing
* Accessories
* Artwork
* Handmade goods
* Beauty products
* Hobby products

Digital products can include:

* Templates
* Ebooks
* Guides
* Checklists
* Educational resources
* Printables
* Design assets
* Spreadsheets

Digital products can be particularly useful for creators because they can be delivered electronically without physical inventory.

For example, a creator teaching productivity could make a downloadable planner.

A designer could sell templates.

A career creator could offer a resume template.

A study creator could develop study resources.

Your TikTok content can provide useful free information while the product offers a more detailed resource.

5. Offer Your Skills as a Service

You do not need to create a product to make money with TikTok.

If you already have a valuable skill, you can use your videos to attract potential clients.

Services could include:

* SEO
* Writing
* Graphic design
* Video editing
* Website development
* Photography
* Tutoring
* Consulting
* Translation
* Social media management

The content itself acts as a public demonstration of your expertise.

For example, a video editor can show how a basic clip can be improved.

An SEO professional can explain common website mistakes.

A designer can explain why certain layouts work better.

A tutor can answer frequently asked questions.

Someone who finds the content useful may eventually inquire about your services.

Why This Can Work With a Small Audience

Service businesses do not necessarily need millions of viewers.

If your content reaches people who actually need the service, even a smaller audience can produce relevant inquiries.

This is one reason niche content can be valuable.

6. Create UGC for Companies

User-generated content is another option for creators who enjoy making videos.

UGC creators produce videos that companies may use in their marketing.

The content can include:

* Product demonstrations
* Tutorials
* Testimonials
* Unboxing-style videos

* Voiceovers
* Lifestyle clips
* Problem-and-solution videos

The company may use the content on its own social accounts, website, or advertising campaigns, depending on the agreement.

One potential advantage is that your personal follower count may not be the main factor.

The company may simply want someone who can create authentic-looking short-form content.

How to Build a UGC Portfolio

You can start by creating sample videos using products you already own.

Create different styles such as:

1. Product demonstration
2. Tutorial
3. Problem-and-solution video
4. Voiceover
5. Testimonial-style video

This gives potential clients examples of your production ability.

7. Use TikTok to Promote a Business

The final method is broader than traditional creator monetization.

You can use TikTok to generate customers for an existing business.

For example:

A restaurant can showcase food.

A fitness professional can share educational content.

A marketing agency can publish practical tips.

A local service provider can answer customer questions.

An online store can demonstrate products.

In this model, TikTok does not necessarily pay you directly.

Instead, the platform helps you reach potential customers.

That can be especially valuable for businesses where one new customer is worth considerably more than the revenue generated by a single social media view.

How Do You Make Money on TikTok as a Beginner?

If you are starting from zero, do not try to build everything simultaneously.

Start with three basic decisions.

Choose Your Topic

Pick something you understand or can consistently learn about.

Identify Your Audience

Ask who would actually benefit from your content.

Pick One Monetization Method

For example:

* Affiliate marketing
* Services
* UGC
* Digital products

You can add more methods later.

Trying to promote five unrelated products on a new account can make your content feel unfocused.

How to Make Money on TikTok Without Followers

You may not need a large following to begin exploring monetization.

For example, UGC opportunities can focus on your video-creation skills rather than your audience size.

A freelancer can use educational content to attract clients.

Affiliate videos can reach people through TikTok recommendations and search.

A local business can use videos to reach nearby customers.

This does not mean followers are unimportant.

It simply means there are monetization methods where follower count is not the only consideration.

How to Make Money on TikTok Videos

A useful way to approach video monetization is to connect each video with a specific purpose.

For example:

Tutorial → Affiliate recommendation

You teach viewers how to solve a problem and recommend a relevant tool.

Expert advice → Service

You demonstrate expertise and attract potential customers.

Product demonstration → Brand or UGC opportunity

You demonstrate that you can create compelling product content.

Educational content → Digital product

You provide useful information and offer a more detailed resource.

This creates a natural relationship between content and revenue.

How to Get Monetized on TikTok

If you are interested in TikTok's direct monetization features, start by checking your account.

The general process is:

1. Create original content.
2. Keep your account in good standing.
3. Build an audience.
4. Meet the requirements of the specific monetization program.
5. Check which features are available in your region.
6. Apply or activate the relevant program when eligible.

Requirements can differ between features.

Do not assume that eligibility for one monetization feature means you automatically qualify for another.

TikTok Creator Rewards Program Requirements

The Creator Rewards Program has specific eligibility conditions that can change over time.

Depending on the market and current rules, requirements may involve:

* Minimum age
* Minimum followers
* Minimum qualifying views

* Original content
* Account standing
* Regional availability

The exact requirements should be checked through current TikTok information rather than an old blog post.

This is especially important because creator monetization programs can change.

TikTok Creator Fund vs Creator Rewards Program

Many people searching for **how to make money on TikTok** still encounter the term "Creator Fund."

The Creator Fund was an earlier TikTok creator payment program.

The Creator Rewards Program represents a newer approach in supported markets.

Therefore, if you are researching TikTok monetization today, do not automatically apply old Creator Fund requirements or payment estimates to your account.

Instead, check the programs currently shown in your TikTok creator tools.

How Much Money Can You Make on TikTok?

There is no guaranteed amount.

Income can depend on:

* Audience size
* Audience location

* Content category
* Engagement
* Monetization method
* Brand deals
* Affiliate conversion
* Product sales
* Service pricing
* Qualifying TikTok activity

A creator who sells a high-value service may earn more from a few clients than another creator earns from a much larger number of views.

That is why total views should not be the only metric you use to evaluate your account.

Can You Make Money on TikTok Without Showing Your Face?

Yes.

Many types of content can be produced without appearing on camera.

Examples include:

* Screen recordings
* Voiceovers
* Gaming videos
* Tutorials
* Animations
* Product demonstrations
* Hands-only videos
* Educational graphics

For example, a software creator can record their screen and explain each step using narration.

A gaming creator can combine gameplay with commentary.

A product creator can demonstrate an item using close-up footage.

The format should fit your topic and audience.

Can You Make Money on TikTok Without Going Viral?

Yes.

Going viral can create significant exposure, but it is not required for every monetization strategy.

A creator can build a smaller audience around a specific topic and monetize that audience through products, services, affiliate recommendations, or sponsorships.

For example, a creator who teaches a specific software program may only attract a niche audience, but that audience can be highly relevant to software-related services or affiliate offers.

The goal should be to attract the right viewers, not simply the largest possible number of viewers.

How to Make Money from TikTok in the Philippines

Creators in the Philippines may have different monetization options from creators in other countries.

If you are searching for the **Creator Rewards Program in the Philippines**, check the current availability and eligibility directly through your TikTok account.

Regional differences can affect which creator programs, shopping features, or LIVE monetization options are available.

Creators can also explore:

* Affiliate marketing
* Sponsorships
* UGC
* Services
* Digital products
* Business promotion
* LIVE features where eligible

Do not assume that a monetization feature available in another country is automatically available in the Philippines.

How to Build a TikTok Account That Can Make Money

A monetizable account usually starts with a clear content strategy.

1. Pick a Specific Topic

Choose a subject rather than posting completely unrelated videos.

2. Create Useful Content

Teach something, solve a problem, entertain viewers, or provide another clear form of value.

3. Develop a Recognizable Format

You might use tutorials, reviews, explanations, comparisons, stories, or demonstrations.

4. Build Trust

Avoid exaggerated claims and misleading promotions.

5. Introduce Monetization Naturally

Once you understand your audience, choose products, services, or opportunities that make sense for them.

6. Track Results

Look beyond views.

Pay attention to:

* Profile visits
* Comments
* Saves
* Shares
* Clicks
* Leads
* Sales

* Inquiries

Free Tools You Can Use to Start

You do not need an expensive studio to begin.

A basic setup can include:

* Smartphone camera
* Free video editor
* Natural lighting
* Simple background
* Free graphic tools
* Notes app for content planning

As your account grows, you can decide whether additional equipment or software is worth the investment.

Starting simple can also help you test your niche before spending money.

Mistakes New TikTok Creators Should Avoid

Buying Followers

Artificial followers do not provide a genuine audience and can create account-related risks.

Copying Viral Content

Study successful formats, but create original versions with your own ideas and presentation.

Making Every Video a Sales Pitch

People usually follow creators for entertainment, information, or another form of value.

Promoting Irrelevant Products

A product should make sense for your audience.

Expecting Instant Income

Audience building and monetization can take time.

Using Outdated Monetization Information

TikTok programs can change. Always check current requirements.

Tips for Experienced Creators

If you already have an established account, your strategy can become more sophisticated.

Diversify Income

Do not rely entirely on one revenue source.

Develop Long-Term Brand Relationships

Instead of chasing one-off sponsorships, focus on partnerships that fit your niche.

Create Owned Assets

A website, email list, product catalog, or business can reduce dependence on a single social platform.

Analyze Your Best Content

Look for patterns in topics, hooks, formats, and audience response.

Improve Conversion

If your videos receive plenty of views but generate few sales or inquiries, examine what happens after viewers visit your profile.

Frequently Asked Questions

How to make money with TikTok?

You can explore creator monetization programs, sponsorships, affiliate marketing, products, digital products, services, UGC, LIVE features, and business lead generation.

Can you make money on TikTok with a small following?

Yes, depending on the monetization method. UGC, services, affiliate marketing, and niche business promotion can be explored without relying entirely on a huge follower count.

How do you make money on TikTok without selling products?

You can potentially earn through eligible creator programs, sponsorships, UGC, affiliate marketing, or by attracting customers to a service business.

How to make money on TikTok videos?

Create original videos around a specific audience and connect them with an appropriate revenue source such as affiliate products, sponsorships, services, UGC, products, or creator programs.

How to get monetized on TikTok?

Check your account's available monetization features and review the current eligibility requirements for the specific program you want to use.

Is the TikTok Creator Fund still available?

The Creator Fund was an earlier TikTok creator monetization program. TikTok has since introduced newer systems, including the Creator Rewards Program in supported markets.

What is the Creator Rewards Program?

It is a TikTok monetization program for eligible creators in supported markets. Requirements and availability can vary by region and may change over time.

Can you make money on TikTok without showing your face?

Yes. Screen recordings, gaming content, tutorials, voiceovers, product demonstrations, animations, and hands-only videos can all be used.

How much does TikTok pay creators?

There is no universal payment amount. Direct TikTok earnings depend on the specific monetization program and its rules, while sponsorships, affiliate income, services, and products use completely different payment models.

Can you make money on TikTok without going viral?

Yes. A focused audience can create opportunities through affiliate marketing, services, sponsorships, UGC, products, and other monetization methods.

Final Thoughts

If you are learning **how to make money with TikTok**, start by understanding that there is more than one path.

The Creator Rewards Program can provide an option for eligible creators, while sponsorships, affiliate marketing, products, services, UGC, and business promotion can create additional opportunities.

Beginners should focus on building useful content around a clear topic instead of trying to monetize everything immediately. Experienced creators can gradually diversify their income and develop assets outside TikTok as their audience grows.

The most important part is creating content that gives people a reason to watch and follow you. Once you understand your audience, choose a monetization method that naturally fits what they already care about.

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